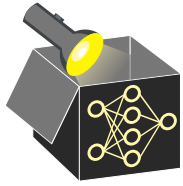
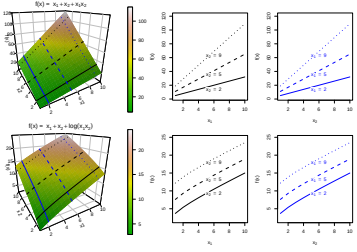
Interpretable Machine Learning



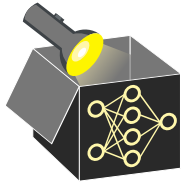
Intro to IML
Feature Interactions



Learning goals

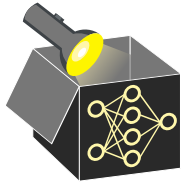
- Feature interactions
- Difference to feature dependencies

FEATURE INTERACTIONS



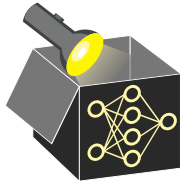
- Feature dependencies concern data distribution
- Feature interactions may occur in structure of **both** model or DGP (e.g., functional relationship between X and $\hat{f}(X)$ or X and $Y = f(X)$)
  $\rightsquigarrow$ Feature dependencies may lead to feature interactions in a model

FEATURE INTERACTIONS

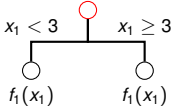


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- No. of potential interactions increases exponentially with no. of features
  $\rightsquigarrow$ Difficult to identify interactions, especially when features are dep.

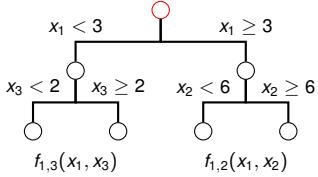
FEATURE INTERACTIONS



- Feature dependencies concern data distribution
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  $\rightsquigarrow$ Feature dependencies may lead to feature interactions in a model
- No. of potential interactions increases exponentially with no. of features
  $\rightsquigarrow$ Difficult to identify interactions, especially when features are dep.
- Interactions: Feature's effect on the prediction depends on other features
  $\rightsquigarrow$ Example: $\hat{f}(\mathbf{x}) = x_1 x_2 \Rightarrow$ Effect of x_1 on $\hat{f}$ depends on x_2 and vice versa



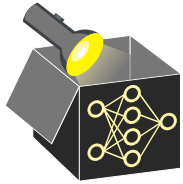
No interaction



Interactions: x_1 and x_3,
x_1 and x_2
No interactions: x_2 and x_3

FEATURE INTERACTIONS

▸ "Friedman and Popescu" 2008



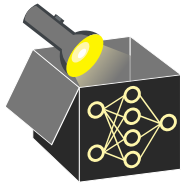
Definition: A function $f(\mathbf{x})$ contains an interaction between x_j and x_k if a difference in $f(\mathbf{x})$-values due to changes in x_j will also depend on x_k, i.e.:

$$\mathbb{E}\left[\frac{\partial^2 f(\mathbf{x})}{\partial x_j \partial x_k}\right]^2 > 0$$

$\Rightarrow$ If x_j and x_k don't interact, $f(\mathbf{x})$ is sum of 2 functions, each indep. of x_j, x_k:

$$f(\mathbf{x}) = f_{-j}(x_1, \ldots, x_{j-1}, x_{j+1}, \ldots, x_p) + f_{-k}(x_1, \ldots, x_{k-1}, x_{k+1}, \ldots, x_p)$$

FEATURE INTERACTIONS

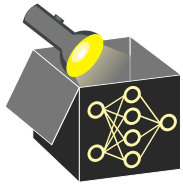


Example: $f(\mathbf{x}) = x_1 + x_2 + x_1 \cdot x_2$ (not separable)

$$\mathbb{E}\left[\frac{\partial^2(x_1+x_2+x_1\cdot x_2)}{\partial x_1 \partial x_2}\right]^2 = \mathbb{E}\left[\frac{\partial(1+x_2)}{\partial x_2}\right]^2 = 1 > 0$$

$\Rightarrow$ interaction between x_1 and x_2

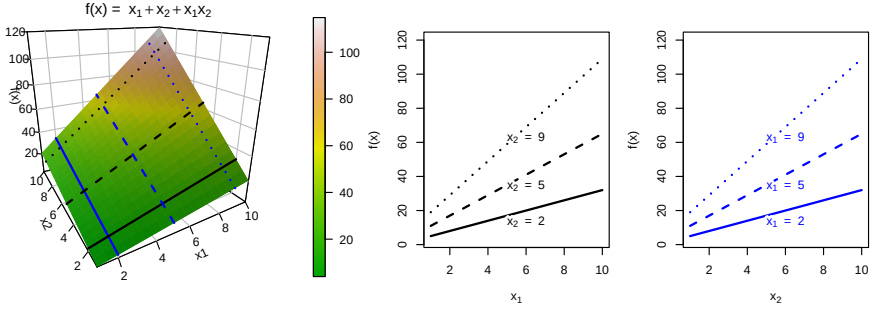
FEATURE INTERACTIONS



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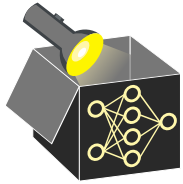
$\Rightarrow$ interaction between x_1 and x_2



- Effect of x_1 on $f(\mathbf{x})$ varies with x_2 (and vice versa)

$\Rightarrow$ Different slopes

FEATURE INTERACTIONS



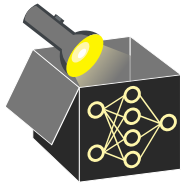
Example of separable function:

$$f(\mathbf{x}) = x_1 + x_2 + \log(x_1 \cdot x_2) = x_1 + x_2 + \log(x_1) + \log(x_2)$$

$\Rightarrow f(\mathbf{x}) = f_1(x_1) + f_2(x_2)$ with $f_1(x_1) = x_1 + \log(x_1)$ and $f_2(x_2) = x_2 + \log(x_2)$

$\Rightarrow$ no interactions due to separability, also $\mathbb{E}\left[\frac{\partial^2 f(\mathbf{x})}{\partial x_1 \partial x_2}\right]^2 = 0$

FEATURE INTERACTIONS

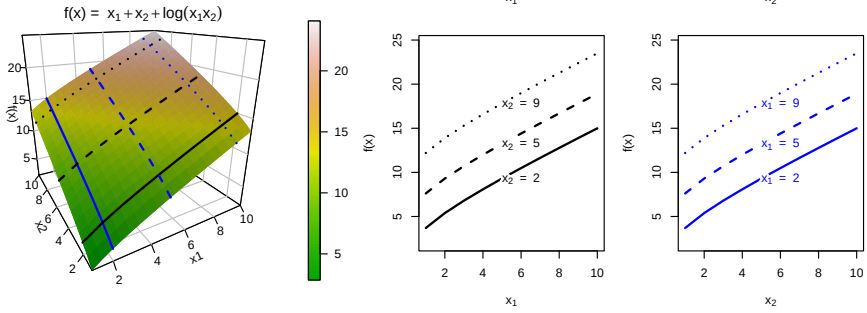


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$\Rightarrow$ no interactions due to separability, also $\mathbb{E}\left[\frac{\partial^2 f(\mathbf{x})}{\partial x_1 \partial x_2}\right]^2 = 0$



- Effect of x_1 on $f(\mathbf{x})$ stays the same for different x_2 values (and vice versa)

$\Rightarrow$ Parallel lines at different horizontal (blue) or vertical (black) slices